Reading and writing

2026-11-17 | Week 6 | Observe and explain

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D

3.8C: Analyze plot elements, including the sequence of events, the conflict, and the resolution. In plain English: Explain the order of story events, the problem and how it is solved. 3.7D: Retell and paraphrase texts in ways that maintain meaning and logical order. In plain English: Retell or put a text into your own words while keeping its meaning and order. Today: Retell the important events in order using three picture cards.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C

4.8C: Analyze plot elements, including the rising action, climax, falling action, and resolution. In plain English: Explain how a story builds to its turning point and moves toward a solution. 4.7C: Use text evidence to support an appropriate response. In plain English: Support an answer with something the text actually says or shows. Today: Analyze the sequence of events and identify the turning point.

I Do

Book connection: Sequence the family's problem, saving actions and the result they celebrate together. Read a short, accessible scene from A Chair for My Mother. Show a visual sequence strip: beginning, middle, end. Ask the shared WH question, "Who is here, where are they, and what happens first?" Model pointing to a picture, choosing an answer card, using AAC or dictating a sentence. Then connect the same scene to each learner's target: Grade 3 retell the important events in order using three picture cards.; Grade 4 analyze the sequence of events and identify the turning point..

We Do

Return to A Chair for My Mother and use its pictures, props or vocabulary as the context. Reread the same scene aloud. Both learners use the same book, illustrations and three-part sequence mat. Ask who, what, where, when, why and how questions about the beginning, middle and end. Grade 3 arranges picture cards and answers with pointing, speech, AAC or dictation. Grade 4 explains the event, character action or evidence using the same page. Fade the model, switch teacher rotations, then revisit the visual sequence.

You Do

Use one fresh WH question about A Chair for My Mother: "What happened at the beginning, middle or end, and how do you know?" Grade 3: Retell the important events in order using three picture cards. Grade 4: Analyze the sequence of events and identify the turning point. Record the page or illustration, response mode, prompt level and whether the student identified the story-structure element.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: The learner not with the teacher uses a previously taught three-picture sequence, WH picture sort, character/setting match or known Vizzle task from A Chair for My Mother. When finished, the learner may complete the week's book craft or quiet enrichment. The teacher then switches and teaches the other learner from the same scene.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. This is practice evidence unless today is a scheduled graded product. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

Real books: A Chair for My Mother. Bring the props and response mats in the weekly book guide.

Book connection for this subject

A Chair for My Mother | Sequence the family's problem, saving actions and the result they celebrate together.

Writing TEKS 3.7B

Write a response to a literary or informational text that demonstrates an understanding of a text.

Writing TEKS 4.7B

Write responses that demonstrate understanding of texts, including comparing and contrasting ideas across a variety of sources.

Writing and spelling

After the shared read-aloud and comprehension sequence, each learner makes an individual response from the same book. Grade 3: Retell the important events in order using three picture cards. Grade 4: Analyze the sequence of events and identify the turning point. Offer large primary writing lines, a picture-to-sentence frame, tracing, dictation or AAC. Record composition separately from oral or picture evidence.

Visual WH and story-structure routine

Use the same book for both learners. Show who, what, where, when, why and how picture cards. Ask about the beginning, middle and end. Arrange three scene cards, then let each learner answer with pointing, AAC, speech, dictation or writing. Record the response mode and prompt level.

Craft or enrichment after comprehension

Create a goal jar with picture contributions and a beginning-middle-end celebration scene.

8-9 AM read-aloud

A Chair for My Mother by Vera B. Williams. Return to the real pages for evidence; see the weekly book guide.

Math

2026-11-17 | Week 6 | Observe and explain

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.3C, 3.3D

3.3C: Explain that the unit fraction 1/b represents the quantity formed by one part of a whole that has been partitioned into b equal parts where b is a non-zero whole number. In plain English: Explain that a unit fraction is one equal part of a whole. 3.3D: Compose and decompose a fraction a/b with a numerator greater than zero and less than or equal to b as a sum of parts 1/b. In plain English: Build and break apart a fraction as a sum of unit fractions. Today: Make one whole from fourths; separate it into two smaller fractional amounts.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.3C, 4.3D

4.3C: Determine if two given fractions are equivalent using a variety of methods. In plain English: Determine whether two fractions name the same amount. 4.3D: Compare two fractions with different numerators and different denominators and represent the comparison using the symbols >, =, or <. In plain English: Compare fractions with different numerators and denominators using >, = or <. Today: Compare one half with three fourths using matching whole lengths.

I Do

Book connection: Use coins, counters or measurement strips to model repeated contributions toward a goal. Grade 3: Join three one-fourth pieces to make three fourths. Separate into two fourths and one fourth. Grade 4: Place one half and one fourth on equal-size wholes. Show the greater amount and compare two fourths with one half.

We Do

Return to A Chair for My Mother and use its pictures, props or vocabulary as the context. Both students handle the shared materials. Practice one example with the teacher; then teach the two targets in separate rotations. Grade 4: compare 1/2 and 3/4 on equal-length wholes and record 1/2 < 3/4. This pair has different numerators and denominators.

You Do

Grade 3: Make one whole from fourths; separate it into two smaller fractional amounts. Grade 4: Compare one half with three fourths using matching whole lengths.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: Complete a mastered counting/sorting tray or known Bridges practice task at the student's established level.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. This is practice evidence unless today is a scheduled graded product. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

Counters, plates/cups and the linked math mat. Select the matching grade-level STEMscopes lesson. Use Bridges placement to choose a separate foundational intervention. Add a visual or prop from A Chair for My Mother that represents this connection.

Book connection for this subject

A Chair for My Mother | Use coins, counters or measurement strips to model repeated contributions toward a goal.

Science

2026-11-17 | Week 6 | Observe and explain

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.8A

3.8A: Identify everyday examples of energy, including light, sound, thermal, and mechanical. In plain English: Recognize everyday examples of light, sound, thermal and mechanical energy. Today: Identify everyday forms of energy.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.7

4.7: Plan and conduct descriptive investigations to explore the patterns of forces such as gravity, friction, or magnetism in contact or at a distance on an object. In plain English: Plan and conduct investigations to find patterns in gravity, friction or magnetism. Today: Test a pattern in gravity, friction or magnetism.

I Do

Book connection: Test a small chair or cart on ramps and surfaces; describe how the energy or speed changes. Grade 3: Show a flashlight, shaker, safely lukewarm sealed bottle and moving car. Name light, sound, thermal and mechanical energy. Grade 4: Compare the same car on smooth board and felt; test a magnet near a paper clip; release a ball into a tray.

We Do

Return to A Chair for My Mother and use its pictures, props or vocabulary as the context. Predict with objects or pictures, test together, then identify what changed. Keep one test variable different and other relevant conditions the same.

You Do

Grade 3: Match an object to its energy form; demonstrate one observable change. Grade 4: Show friction, magnetic attraction or gravity using observed evidence.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: Sort familiar object/photo matches away from the experiment station. Experiments are adult supervised.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. This is practice evidence unless today is a scheduled graded product. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

Toy car, low ramp, stable blocks, felt, tray, tape, fraction strips, historical pictures. Adult manages circuit parts, magnets, small items and warm materials; use a low-voltage kit only. Add a visual or prop from A Chair for My Mother that represents this connection.

Book connection for this subject

A Chair for My Mother | Test a small chair or cart on ramps and surfaces; describe how the energy or speed changes.

Social studies

2026-11-17 | Week 6 | Observe and explain

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.14B

3.14B: Differentiate and compare the information about a specific issue or event provided in primary and secondary sources. In plain English: Compare what firsthand sources and later accounts say about the same issue or event. Today: Compare an original photo with a later account of the same event.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.3A

4.3A: Analyze the causes, major events, and effects of the Texas Revolution, including the Battle of the Alamo, the Texas Declaration of Independence, the Runaway Scrape, and the Battle of San Jacinto. In plain English: Explain causes, major events and effects of the Texas Revolution. Today: Place two major Revolution events in order.

I Do

Book connection: Identify family, neighbor and community support and explain how each action helps. Grade 3: Compare an original photo with a later account of the same event. Model with one district source, naming the visible clue. Grade 4: Place two major Revolution events in order. Use the current Texas history map, image or excerpt; name the person/event and point to the evidence.

We Do

Return to A Chair for My Mother and use its pictures, props or vocabulary as the context. Work together with a second example from the same source set. Student circles/points to the part of the source that answers the question. Keep the grade-specific question visible and fade added hints.

You Do

Grade 3: Compare an original photo with a later account of the same event. Grade 4: Place two major Revolution events in order. Use a fresh source/card; accept a model, pointing, AAC or a spoken explanation.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: Match two familiar source pictures or complete a known picture-to-object task.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. This is practice evidence unless today is a scheduled graded product. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

District source pictures or excerpts, two-event sequence mat and writing/history frames. The classroom texts do not replace Texas history sources. Add a visual or prop from A Chair for My Mother that represents this connection.

Book connection for this subject

A Chair for My Mother | Identify family, neighbor and community support and explain how each action helps.